

Cover Letter

Dear Dr. Neils,

I am writing to apply for the Field Research Associate for your research on urban labour market responses to extreme temperatures and air pollution in Delhi. I am a Delhi-based economics graduate with native Hindi proficiency, available for the full two-week engagement starting 10 July 2026.

Relevant Coursework and Subject fit

My undergraduate coursework at the University of Delhi includes Development Economics, Indian Growth and Development, Comparative Economic Development, and Development Theory and Experience; directly relevant to the urban labour and informal economy. I have also completed Research Methodology for Economics, covering research design, data collection methods, and qualitative field methods, along with Environmental Economics and Introduction to Causal Inference for the empirical dimensions of the project. I am well versed in Econometrics through coursework such as Basic Econometrics, Advanced Econometrics, and Forecasting Methods for Economics.

Research Capability

My undergraduate thesis titled “Carbon Emissions in Africa: EKC and Regional Integration” was graded 10/10 (O grade), the highest in the department, and presented at UGREE 2026. My first-author paper is currently under peer review at Ecology, Economy and Society (EES) Special Edition. While my research experience to date is quantitative (panel data econometrics), I am familiar with the research process completely from literature review, research design, data collection, to final analysis and am prepared to conduct qualitative field interviews under your guidance.

Language and Local Knowledge

Hindi is my native language; English is my working language. I am Delhi-based with familiarity with the city’s geography, labour-market scenario, and informal-sector dynamics. I am comfortable with real-time Hindi↔English interpretation and transcription. I also have conversational Punjabi comprehension (both parents are of Punjabi heritage) as I can understand spoken Punjabi at basic level, though I am not literate in the script.

I have attached my CV. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss the project in more detail.

Sincerely,

Hridayam Kapila

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